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uge **The Hag’s Panopticon**  
large A OneShot for Fate’s Edge

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Designed for 34 hours; Tone: paranoia, social intrigue, folkhorror

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## Section How to Use This Document

This packet is ready to run. Sections are ordered the way you'll need them at the table:

tem **Overview Themes** the premise, mood, and core tensions. tem **Character Creation** prompts and guidelines for building characters suited to this scenario. tem **Act Structure** four acts with beats and decision points. tem **NPC Roster** named roles with open/secret agendas. tem **Key Locations** quick, evocative details and map prompts. tem **Scene Encounter Frames** tension beats and soft timers. tem **The Hag's Low Rites** paranoia-fueled tools (Mab-flavored, twisted). tem **Corruption: The Hag** subtle tells to catch servants. tem **GM Tools** SB spends, sample timers, and reveals menu. tem **Player Handouts** table-friendly summaries.

**Fate's Edge Fit:** Use Position (Dominant/Dominant/Desperate), Boons/SB economy, and scene timers. Keep the Hag *felt*, not always *seen*.

## Section Character Creation

### Subsection Recommended Backgrounds

Players should consider backgrounds that emphasize:

tem **Social manipulation** (Sway, Deceit, Command) tem **Insight into human behavior** (Notice, Insight, Lore) tem **Stealth and infiltration** (Stealth, Mobility) tem **Resilience to mental strain** (Resolve, Spirit)

### Subsection Suggested Drives

tem **Uncover the Truth** You seek to expose the hidden mechanisms of control. tem **Escape at Any Cost** Freedom is your only goal; others may be sacrificed. tem **Protect the Innocent** You believe some here are truly innocent and must be saved.

### Subsection Skill Suggestions

tem **Investigation Skills:** Notice, Insight, Lore tem **Social Skills:** Sway, Command, Deceit tem **Stealth Skills:** Stealth, Mobility tem **Resilience Skills:** Resolve, Spirit

## Largepesection Overview Themes

### largepesubsection Premise

Shipwrecked (or captured), the PCs awaken on an island “rehabilitation colony” run by a Hag. The colony’s social order is engineered so no one can say who is *prisoner* and who is *guard*. Roles invert midscene; memory and narrative contradict. Escape is possible, overthrow is possible, submission is tempting.

### largepesubsection Themes

tem **Masks and Roles:** Identity is a costume; truth is a performance. tem **Paranoia as Power:** Doubt fuels control; trust becomes a resource. tem **Bargains Over Bars:** Walls exist, but *social architecture* is the real prison.

### largepesubsection Tone Guide

Folkhorror unease, candlelit communal halls, whispers through the walls, public rituals of “confession,” kindness with a hook.

### largepesubsection Outcomes at a Glance

tem **Escape:** Flee by sea; the Hag’s influence lingers. tem **Overthrow:** Break her control; inherit a broken community. tem **Submission:** Walk free as her agents beyond the island.

## Largepesection Act Structure

### largepesubsection Act I: Arrival Orientation

**Hook:** PCs awaken in the infirmary; they are “new arrivals.” A communal meal follows.

tem **Read:** smiles, contradictions, missing names. tem **Tell:** no one states their role plainly. tem **Clue seeds (choose 12):**tem A “guard” takes orders from a “prisoner” without comment. tem A hymn switches verses midphrase, as if someone else is speaking. tem A masked figure watches from a reflection, not the doorway.

### largepesubsection Act II: The Crack in the Facade

Assign mundane labor (wall repair, kitchens, docks). During the task, reveal the first *break*.

tem **Factions:** Conspirators (escape), True Believers (devotion), Traders (barter to survive). tem **Beat:** a public “discipline” where roles invert: today’s enforcer is punished as a traitor.

### largepesubsection Act III: The Hag’s Game

The Hag contacts a PC (dream, whisper, or proxy). Offer three bargains:

tem **Submission:** Serve as her watchers (leave later as agents). tem **Escape:** She opens a path if they betray someone. tem **Overthrow:** “If you think you can.” (She tightens the screws.)

## largepesection Act IV: Resolution

tem **Escape:** Reach the sabotaged skiff; storms and watchers oppose you. tem **Overthrow:** Confront the Hag's locus (chapel mirror, cistern, or masked warden). Shatter the mechanism of control. tem **Submission:** The Hag grants passage; PCs bear her mark.

**Positioning Advice:** Social scenes start *Dominant*; a public reveal pushes to *Desperate*. Use Boons to step up Position or seed Assists; 1s feed your SB.

## Largepesection NPC Roster

### largepesection The Hag (Warden Mother)

**Face:** Rarely seen directly; appears in reflections, as a masked "warden," or as a kindly voice.

tem **Agenda:** Preserve the panopticon; harvest secrets and bargains. tem **Levers:** Role inversion, dreambargains, public rituals of confession. tem **If cornered:** She does not flee; she *recasts the scene*: who is confessing now?

### largepesection Seris (The Kindly Healer)

**Mask:** Prisoner (nurturing, softspoken). **Truth:** Senior watcher.

tem **Wants:** Convert PCs into cooperative assets. tem **Tells:** Always sits with her back to mirrors; never states a role. tem **Offer:** Protection if you "help" identify agitators.

### largepesection Gorvik (The Gruff Enforcer)

**Mask:** Guard (stern, dutiful). **Truth:** Desperate conspirator.

tem **Wants:** Outbut won't risk others lightly. tem **Tells:** Winces when giving orders; works hardest at menial tasks. tem **Offer:** Quiet favors; asks for proof PCs won't betray him.

### largepesection Three Quick Extras

tem **The Believer:** Reports everything. (Is it piety, or leverage?) tem **The Skeptic:** Knows too much; paralyzed by fear. tem **The Ghost:** Swears they died here and woke up again.

**Portrayal Note:** Swap an NPC's displayed role midscene once per act. Let the table feel the rugpulls.

## Largepesection Key Locations

### largepesection Longhouse (Common Hall)

**Read:** Smokesweet air, communal benches, masks hung like trophies. **Secrets:** A slat behind the choir dais hides a crawlspace to the Chapel. **Tension Beat:** A public confession each evening; roles invert midritual.

### largepesection Infirmary (Wards Whispers)

**Read:** Herbbitter linen, quiet footfalls, mirror above the washbasin. **Secrets:** The mirror is her favored locus; speaking a name to it summons a watcher. **Tension Beat:** A "patient" orders a "nurse"; no one reacts as if odd.

## largepesubsection Chapel (Masks Reflections)

**Read:** Beeswax, iron bell rope, a silvered altar. **Secrets:** The altar's reflection reveals the Hag's masked warden even when she is absent. **Tension Beat:** The hymn shifts voice midverse as though the island sings back.

## largepesubsection Workyard (Labor Leverage)

**Read:** Salt air, pile of nets, wall repair scaffold. **Secrets:** A loose stone conceals a smuggled lockpick and a conspirator's note. **Tension Beat:** An enforcer is punished as a traitor today's guard is tomorrow's prisoner.

## largepesubsection Docks (Hope Sabotage)

**Read:** Splintered skiff, barnacled pilings, treacherous reef. **Secrets:** The only seaworthy skiff needs a sparkstone (kept in the Chapel). **Tension Beat:** Fog arrives unnaturally fast; a watcher "was always here."

## Largepesection Scene Encounter Frames

### largepesubsection Soft Timers (Examples)

tem **Trust Frays** (4tick): Allies refuse to Assist; social Position worsens. tem **Watcher's Eye** (6tick): The Hag acts directly (insert a bargain/punishment). tem **Sabotage at the Docks** (4tick): Skiff rendered useless until repaired. tem **Riot Spark** (6tick): Crowd turns; public violence or purge.

### largepesubsection Social Pressure Frames

Start *Dominant*. Any public reveal, accusation, or role inversion can drop to *Desperate*. Award Boons on Partials/Misses to keep momentum; every rolled 1 seeds GM SB.

### largepesubsection Custom SB Spend Menus

sectionSB Spend: Social Paranoia (Common Hall / Chapel)

#### rule SB Spend (Social)

rule 1 A bystander "remembers" the PCs differently; worsen Position by 1 for the current exchange.

1 A trusted NPC hesitates; remove 1 Assist die from the next ally roll.

2 Seed a *Trust Frays* tick (2); the targeted PC must answer a pointed question or take 1 die on next social roll.

2 A mask changes hands offscreen; an NPC's apparent role flips for the scene.

3 Public Confession: someone is forced to accuse a PC or ally; all social rolls against True Believers are *Desperate* this scene.

4 Command Performance: the Hag speaks through a reflection; she names a cost (betray X or accept a Mark). Refusal advances *Watcher's Eye* by 2.

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sectionSB Spend: Escape Pressure (Workyard / Docks)

rule **SB Spend (Escape)**

rule 1 Sudden fog; worsen environmental Position for stealth/scan checks.

1 A rope snaps; mark 1 Fatigue on the acting PC unless they drop gear.

2 Sabotage blooms: tick *Sabotage at the Docks* twice.

2 Witnessed: a watcher appears where no one was; next action vs. the watcher is *Desperate*.

3 Panic spreads; introduce a hostile crowd complication (DV +1 until dispersed).

4 The Hag's Command: choose/abandon one conspirator now, or *Watcher's Eye* fills.

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section **SB Spend: Overthrow Confrontation (Chapel / Locus)**

rule **SB Spend (Overthrow)**

rule 1 Mirrorflash blinds; 1 die to the next direct action against the locus.

2 Role Collapse: one PC momentarily believes they are a guard; they must Act to shake it or suffer 1 die for the scene.

2 Echoed Orders: an ally repeats the Hag's phrasing; sow 1 die to all Teamwork actions this exchange.

3 Mask Shatter: an NPC ally is revealed as a watcher; they impose a hard choice (retreat or split the party).

4 Recast the Scene: immediately flip the fiction (swap who is "accused"); everyone's Position drops by 1 for their next action.

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large **section The Hag's Low Rites (Paranoia Fueled)**

All are *Low Rites* intended for social/intrigue tension. They mirror Mab's toolkit but twist toward gaslighting and identity flux.

large **subsection Wear the Mask**

**Scope:** Scene; Self; Resisted. **Materials:** Mask/veil/shadow/mear. **Effect:** Present as guard or prisoner at will; NPCs accept it unless violently contradicted. **Push:** Learn one target's secret (GM supplies). Costs 1 Corruption on a *Miss*.

large **subsection Whisper of Betrayal**

**Scope:** Scene; Close; Resisted. **Materials:** Shared water; hushed phrase. **Effect:** Target treats an ally as suspicious; 1 die to Assist/Teamwork with that ally. **Push:** Paranoia spreads to the whole group for one exchange.

large **subsection Exchange of Shadows**

**Scope:** Instant; Near; Unresisted. **Materials:** Overlapped shadows. **Effect:** You and a target swap apparent roles; onlookers "remember" it as true. **Push:** Lingers into Downtime; fallout scene required to clear.

## largepbesubsection Eyes in the Walls

**Scope:** Scene; Self; Unresisted. **Materials:** Crack, keyhole, splinter. **Effect:** Observe a nearby scene remotely. **Push:** Receive one *truth* and one *lie*; you don't know which is which (GM marks 1 SB).

## largepbesubsection The Hag's Bargain

**Scope:** Scene; Touch; Resisted. **Materials:** Blood drop or mirror shard. **Effect:** Grant an ally +1 die; if they *Miss*, you mark 1 Corruption. **Push:** If they *Crit*, you still mark 1 Corruption (the Hag always profits).

## Largepesection Corruption: The Hag (Masks Paranoia)

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## largepbesubsection Subtle Tells (Narrative)

tem **Stage 1:** Whispertwitch; facecovering habits; compulsive "are you lying?" asides. tem **Stage 2:** False titles; aversion to mirrors; tattletale reflex to unseen authorities. tem **Stage 3:** Shadow out of sync; gaslight instinct; her tone slips into your voice. tem **Stage 4:** Mirrorglint eye; role amnesia; compulsion to spread her bargains.

## largepbesubsection SRD Track (Condensed)

tem[dexterm13 Corruption] Subtle habits emerge: covering the face, pausing as if listening, probing others for lies. tem[dexterm46 Corruption] Roles blur: false titles, mirror aversion, reflex to report others' actions. tem[dexterm79 Corruption] Paranoia deepens: shadow slip, memorytwisting, the Hag's tones in your speech. tem[dexterm10+ Corruption] Revelation: one eye mirrors dim light; you doubt your role and dream of spreading her bargains.

## Largepesection GM Tools: Paranoia Control

### largepbesubsection Reveal Ladder (Escalation Cues)

Use these stages to track how overt the Hag's influence becomes.

tem **Masks in Motion:** PCs notice minor behavioral tics in NPCs (whispertwitch, compulsive reporting). tem **Role Confusion:** Guards and prisoners invert in public scenes; records contradict themselves. tem **Living Walls:** PCs catch the island itself "watching" whispers in cracks, faces in reflections. tem **The Hag's Voice:** Commands ripple through NPCs; PCs hear her in their own speech. tem **Revelation:** One PC or ally is unmasked as her agent. This is a turning point confrontation, betrayal, or bargain.

## largepbesubsection Timer Suite (Examples)

tem **Trust Frays** (4): Allies hesitate to Aid; social Position worsens. tem **Watcher's Eye** (6): The Hag intervenes directly; insert bargain/punishment. tem **Sabotage at the Docks** (4): Escape route collapses unless countered. tem **Identity Collapse** (6): One PC begins to doubt their own role; must Act to recover.

## largepesection Downtime SB Spend Menu (After Each Session/Scene)

### rule SB Spend (Downtime)

rule 1 A rumor spreads in the cells: PCs suffer 1 die to the next social action unless they quell it.

1 Nightmares visit: mark 1 Fatigue unless a PC takes Watch.

2 A mask "migrates" overnight: swap two NPC roles at the GM's choice.

2 A PC receives a whispered bargain in their dreams; accept a small boon, or mark 1 Corruption.

3 An ally NPC vanishes; next session they return with subtle Stage 2 Corruption.

4 The Hag herself appears in a dream tribunal; one PC must confess or face a scene start at *Desperate*.

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## largepesection GM Reminders

tem Always spend SB to destabilize trust, never just to "add hit points." tem Swap roles subtly; the fiction should feel like sand slipping through fingers. tem Corruption is narrative fuel; feed paranoia slowly, then escalate into overt reveals. tem Use Timers sparingly; fewer, more visible ones emphasize mounting tension.

## Largepesection Player Handout: The Island of Masks

### largepesection Premise (What You Know)

You are confined on an isolated prison island ruled by a mysterious Hag. No one can say with certainty who is a prisoner and who is a guard. Every face wears suspicion; every mask hides a bargain. You have one goal: **survive long enough to find escape or overthrow her hold.**

### largepesection Your Immediate Goals

tem Identify potential allies and conspirators. tem Avoid exposure as traitor or pawn. tem Secure a path off the island skiff, dock, or revolt. tem Decide whether you will confront the Hag directly or flee her grasp.

### largepesection What You Suspect

tem The Hag's servants are hidden among you. tem Masks and roles may shift without warning. tem Bargains are binding, but always slanted in her favor.

## largeSidebar: Spotting the Hag's Servants

Tells in Plain Sight Keep watch for these subtle behaviors:

tem Covering the face or speaking in halfpauses, as if "listening." tem Refusal to meet mirrors or reflective surfaces. tem Compulsively reporting on others' actions to anyone listening. tem Shadows that move just slightly out of step. tem Speech that slips into strange tones or repeats the Hag's phrases.

Each of these hints may mark a servant already sliding under her influence. It is up to you whether to expose them, trust them, or bargain yourself.



## subsection Player Reminders

tem Your Position (Dominant/Dominant/Desperate) matters more than raw damage. tem Boons fuel team momentum; Fatigue and Corruption are longterm costs. tem The Hag thrives on paranoia play into it, but remember: **cooperation is still your strongest weapon.**

## section Closing GM Section: Flow Resolution

### subsection Adventure Flow (3 Acts)

#### Act I: Arrival Unease

tem Introduce the Longhouse or Infirmary; emphasize masks and role confusion. tem Timer : *Trust Frays* (4). Every misstep fuels suspicion. tem Seed subtle corruption tells (whispertwitch, false titles).

#### Act II: Fractures Conspiracies

tem PCs navigate shifting alliances. Push SB spends from the Social Paranoia table. tem Timer : *Watcher's Eye* (6). Advance it whenever bargains are refused. tem Include a reveal ladder step (Role Confusion or Living Walls).

#### Act III: Escape or Overthrow

tem Scene pivot to Docks or Chapel. Choose *Escape* or *Confrontation*. tem Escape uses the *Escape Pressure* SB menu; Overthrow uses *Overthrow Confrontation*. tem Endgame corruption: highlight one PC or ally tipping into Stage 3 or 4.

### subsection Final Confrontation Options

tem[Escape] PCs secure the skiff or another route. Costs: Fatigue + SB; some prisoners left behind. tem[Bargain] PCs accept a deal from the Hag. Corruption flows, but safe passage is granted. tem[Overthrow] PCs confront the Hag in her locus (Chapel/altar reflection). Use Overthrow SB menu.

### subsection Aftermath Table

Roll 1d6 or decide based on play outcomes.

| rule Roll | Aftermath                                                                                              |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| rule 1    | The Hag's power fractures; she vanishes, but masks linger across the isles. PCs gain infamy.           |
| 2         | Escape succeeds, but one PC carries her Stage 4 Corruption a new vector for her influence.             |
| 3         | Bargain accepted: safe passage in exchange for a permanent Mark (all PCs +1 ongoing Corruption track). |
| 4         | Prison revolt succeeds; the Hag's locus destroyed. Survivors establish a fragile new order.            |
| 5         | The Hag withdraws, promising return. PCs carry whispers of her bargains into future play.              |
| 6         | PCs overthrew her utterly. Yet a mirror shard follows them, glinting with potential return.            |

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## largepesubsection GM Wrap Reminders

tem Escalate paranoia gradually: from subtle habits to overt reveals. tem Use SB to warp trust and identity, not to simply add "difficulty." tem Always end with a clear player choice: flee, bargain, or confront. tem Corruption is the long shadow even victory may carry her mark forward.

## Largepesection Generators Quick Tables

### largepesubsection NPC Generator (Prisoner or Guard?)

Roll 1d6 or choose.

rule NPC Trait

d6

- rule 1 **Innocent Face:** Claims ignorance; insists they are wrongly confined. Wears a mask too large.
- 2 **Confessor:** Always eager to whisper someone else's sins; "helps" by reporting.
- 3 **Silent Watcher:** Speaks rarely, but always seems to be in the room you enter next.
- 4 **Bargainer:** Offers aid for a price (a mask, a secret, a wound).
- 5 **Masked Twin:** Looks exactly like another NPC; denies it.
- 6 **Bleeding Voice:** Occasionally slips into the Hag's tones; Stage 2 corruption evident.

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### largepesubsection Island Location Generator

Roll 1d6 or choose.

rule Location Detail

d6

- rule 1 **Collapsed Tower:** Halffallen into the surf; stairwell ends in mist.
- 2 **Mirror Pool:** Still water that reflects someone absent rather than present.
- 3 **Mask Garden:** Broken masks hang from posts, swaying as if in wind.
- 4 **Sealed Cell:** Door bolted from inside; scratching still audible.
- 5 **Hollow Tree:** Whispers echo; a prisoner once hid messages here.
- 6 **Chalk Circles:** Faded ritual markings, refreshed when no one watches.

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### largepesubsection Consequences Generator (Deck of Consequences)

Roll 1d6 or choose when a *Miss* or severe cost must land.

rule Consequence

d6

- rule 1 **Fractured Trust:** Allies refuse to Aid until convinced otherwise.
- 2 **Lost Identity:** For one scene, the PC must act as though they are a guard.
- 3 **Corruption Surge:** Mark +2 Corruption immediately.
- 4 **Mirror Mark:** A PC's reflection is missing in one surface; others notice.

- 5      **Broken Escape:** A rope, key, or tool fails at the worst possible time.
- 6      **The Hag's Whisper:** GM declares a bargain offer. Refusal advances *Watcher's Eye* timer by 2.

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## subsection Usage Note

These generators are lightweight tools:

- tem Use NPC traits to blur the line between ally and enemy.
- tem Island details create unease and reinforce the shifting setting.
- tem Consequences escalate paranoia without stalling play.